

# Competition Volume 1

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This devotional is structured for six days of personal reading, reflection, and prayer. Each day follows the same rhythm: a timeless quote, a scripture passage, a reflection, a moment of stillness, action steps, and a closing prayer. Begin on any day of the week. The order within each day is intentional — let each element do its work before moving to the next.

Day 1

Day 2

Day 3

Day 4

Day 5

Day 6

Day 7

Day 8

Day 9

Day 10

Day 11

Day 12

# Timeless Wisdom

*Growth in grace is not the work of a day, nor a month, nor a year, but of a whole life.*

- Arthur W. Pink, Profiting from the Word

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:1-7 (NASB)

*Paul, a bond-servant of Christ Jesus, called [as] an apostle, set apart for the gospel of God, which He promised beforehand through His prophets in the holy Scriptures, concerning His Son, who was born of a descendant of David according to the flesh, who was declared the Son of God with power by the resurrection from the dead, according to the Spirit of holiness, Jesus Christ our Lord, through whom we have received grace and apostleship to bring about [the] obedience of faith among all the Gentiles for His name's sake, among whom you also are the called of Jesus Christ; to all who are beloved of God in Rome, called [as] saints: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.*

## Reflection

Day 1 in the The Gospel | Set apart for the gospel sequence opens with Romans 1:1-7. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: Paul, a bond-servant of Christ Jesus, called [as] an apostle, set apart for the gospel of God, which He promised beforehand through His prophets in the holy Scriptures, concerning His Son, who was born of a descendant of David according. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:1-7 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about Paul, a bond-servant of Christ Jesus, called [as] slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about set apart for the gospel meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:1-7 calls you to live this truth today:

- Write one sentence naming what Set apart for the gospel reveals about God's character, and return to it at midday.
- Choose one ordinary responsibility today and do it slowly, truthfully, and without grumbling.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:1-7 and for showing us Paul, a bond-servant of Christ Jesus, called [as]. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in Set apart for the gospel. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:1-7 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 1 in the The Gospel | Set apart for the gospel sequence opens with Romans 1:1-7. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*Resolved, never to do anything which I should be afraid to do if it were the last hour of my life.*

- Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:8-15 (NASB)

*First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for you all, because your faith is being proclaimed throughout the whole world. For God, whom I serve in my spirit in the [preaching of the] gospel of His Son, is my witness [as to] how unceasingly I make mention of you, always in my prayers making request, if perhaps now at last by the will of God I may succeed in coming to you. For I long to see you so that I may impart some spiritual gift to you, that you may be established; that is, that I may be encouraged together with you [while] among you, each of us by the other's faith, both yours and mine. I do not want you to be unaware, brethren, that often I have planned to come to you (and have been prevented so far) so that I may obtain some fruit among you also, even as among the rest of the Gentiles. I am under obligation both to Greeks and to barbarians, both to the wise and to the foolish. So, for my part, I am eager to preach the gospel to you also who are in Rome.*

## Reflection

Day 2 in the The Gospel | Readiness to preach Christ sequence opens with Romans 1:8-15. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for the reader all, because the reader's faith is being proclaimed throughout the whole world. For God, whom I serve in my spirit in the [preaching of the] gospel of His Son, is my. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:8-15 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about readiness to preach Christ meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:8-15 calls you to live this truth today:

→ Before your next decision, pause and ask how Romans 1:8-15 should shape your response.

→ Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:8-15 and for showing us First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in Readiness to preach Christ. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:8-15 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 2 in the The Gospel | Readiness to preach Christ sequence opens with Romans 1:8-15. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Make our lives more truthful, more restful, and more loving because Your word has met us here. Amen.



# Timeless Wisdom

*The vigor and power and comfort of our spiritual life depend on the mortification of the deeds of the flesh.*

- John Owen, Of the Mortification of Sin

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:16-17 (NASB)

*For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek. For in it [the] righteousness of God is revealed from faith to faith; as it is written, 'BUT THE RIGHTEOUS [man] SHALL LIVE BY FAITH.'*

## Reflection

Day 3 in the The Gospel | The righteousness of God revealed sequence opens with Romans 1:16-17. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek. For in it [the] righteousness of God is revealed from. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without displacing the original meaning: the Creator who speaks order is the same Lord who reconciles creation through grace. The result is not moralism but worship. Faithful obedience grows from confidence in God's prior action. Holiness becomes response, not currency. Hope becomes grounded in God's constancy, not in fluctuating circumstances. The bridge to practice is concrete. Speech is to be truthful because God's word is true. Work is to be ordered because creation is

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:16-17 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about For I am not ashamed of the gospel slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about the righteousness of God revealed meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:16-17 calls you to live this truth today:

- Name one place where you have been trying to control the outcome, and entrust that concern to God in prayer.
- End the day by recording one evidence of God's goodness you noticed in work, rest, or relationships.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:16-17 and for showing us For I am not ashamed of the gospel. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in The righteousness of God revealed. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:16-17 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 3 in the The Gospel | The righteousness of God revealed sequence opens with Romans 1:16-17. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*By perseverance the snail reached the ark.*

- Charles H. Spurgeon, Spurgeon's Sermons

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:18-23 (NASB)

*For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men who suppress the truth in unrighteousness, because that which is known about God is evident within them; for God made it evident to them. For since the creation of the world His invisible attributes, His eternal power and divine nature, have been clearly seen, being understood through what has been made, so that they are without excuse. For even though they knew God, they did not honor Him as God or give thanks, but they became futile in their speculations, and their foolish heart was darkened. Professing to be wise, they became fools, and exchanged the glory of the incorruptible God for an image in the form of corruptible man and of birds and four-footed animals and crawling creatures.*

## Reflection

Day 4 in the Sin | Suppressing the truth sequence opens with Romans 1:18-23. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men who suppress the truth in unrighteousness, because that which is known about God is evident within them; for God made it evident to them.. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:18-23 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about For the wrath of God is revealed from slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about suppressing the truth meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:18-23 calls you to live this truth today:

→ Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Romans 1:18-23.

→ Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:18-23 and for showing us For the wrath of God is revealed from. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in Suppressing the truth. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:18-23 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 4 in the Sin | Suppressing the truth sequence opens with Romans 1:18-23. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Make our lives more truthful, more restful, and more loving because Your word has met us here. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*Prayer will make a man cease from sin, or sin will entice a man to cease from prayer.*

- John Bunyan, A Discourse on Prayer

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:24-27 (NASB)

*Therefore God gave them over in the lusts of their hearts to impurity, so that their bodies would be dishonored among them. For they exchanged the truth of God for a lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever. Amen. For this reason God gave them over to degrading passions; for their women exchanged the natural function for that which is unnatural, and in the same way also the men abandoned the natural function of the woman and burned in their desire toward one another, men with men committing indecent acts and receiving in their own persons the due penalty of their error.*

## Reflection

Day 5 in the Sin | Disordered worship and desire sequence opens with Romans 1:24-27. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: Therefore God gave them over in the lusts of their hearts to impurity, so that their bodies would be dishonored among them. For they exchanged the truth of God for a lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:24-27 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about Therefore God gave them over in the lusts slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where do you need to receive God's order instead of forcing control?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:24-27 calls you to live this truth today:

- Write one sentence naming what Disordered worship and desire reveals about God's character, and return to it at midday.
- Choose one ordinary responsibility today and do it slowly, truthfully, and without grumbling.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:24-27 and for showing us Therefore God gave them over in the lusts. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in Disordered worship and desire. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:24-27 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 5 in the Sin | Disordered worship and desire sequence opens with Romans 1:24-27. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Make our lives more truthful, more restful, and more loving because Your word has met us here. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*A dog barks when his master is attacked. I would be a coward if I saw God's truth attacked and yet would remain silent.*

- John Calvin, Sermons and Letters

## Scripture Reading

Rom 1:28-32 (NASB)

*And just as they did not see fit to acknowledge God any longer, God gave them over to a depraved mind, to do those things which are not proper, being filled with all unrighteousness, wickedness, greed, evil; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, malice; [they are] gossips, slanderers, haters of God, insolent, arrogant, boastful, inventors of evil, disobedient to parents, without understanding, untrustworthy, unloving, unmerciful; and although they know the ordinance of God, that those who practice such things are worthy of death, they not only do the same, but also give hearty approval to those who practice them.*

## Reflection

Day 6 in the Sin | A debased mind and its fruit sequence opens with Romans 1:28-32. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: And just as they did not see fit to acknowledge God any longer, God gave them over to a depraved mind, to do those things which are not proper, being filled with all unrighteousness, wickedness, greed, evil; full of envy,. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without displacing the original meaning:

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 1:28-32 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about And just as they did not see fit slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about a debased mind and its fruit meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 1:28-32 calls you to live this truth today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Romans 1:28-32 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 1:28-32 and for showing us And just as they did not see fit. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in A debased mind and its fruit. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 1:28-32 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 6 in the Sin | A debased mind and its fruit sequence opens with Romans 1:28-32. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.



# Timeless Wisdom

*We are immortal till our work on earth is done.*

- George Whitefield, Journals of George Whitefield

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:1-5 (NASB)

*Therefore you have no excuse, everyone of you who passes judgment, for in that which you judge another, you condemn yourself; for you who judge practice the same things. And we know that the judgment of God rightly falls upon those who practice such things. But do you suppose this, O man, when you pass judgment on those who practice such things and do the same [yourself], that you will escape the judgment of God? Or do you think lightly of the riches of His kindness and tolerance and patience, not knowing that the kindness of God leads you to repentance? But because of your stubbornness and unrepentant heart you are storing up wrath for yourself in the day of wrath and revelation of the righteous judgment of God,*

## Reflection

Day 7 in the Judgment | No excuse for judging others sequence opens with Romans 2:1-5. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: Therefore the reader have no excuse, everyone of the reader who passes judgment, for in that which the reader judge another, the reader condemn yourself; for the reader who judge practice the same things. And we know that the judgment of God rightly falls upon. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:1-5 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about Therefore you have no excuse, everyone of you slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about no excuse for judging others meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:1-5 calls you to live this truth today:

→ Name one place where you have been trying to control the outcome, and entrust that concern to God in prayer.

→ End the day by recording one evidence of God's goodness you noticed in work, rest, or relationships.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:1-5 and for showing us Therefore you have no excuse, everyone of you. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in No excuse for judging others. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:1-5 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 7 in the Judgment | No excuse for judging others sequence opens with Romans 2:1-5. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*I have held many things in my hands, and I have lost them all; but whatever I have placed in God's hands, that I still possess.*

- Martin Luther, Table Talk

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:6-11 (NASB)

*who WILL RENDER TO EACH PERSON ACCORDING TO HIS DEEDS: to those who by perseverance in doing good seek for glory and honor and immortality, eternal life; but to those who are selfishly ambitious and do not obey the truth, but obey unrighteousness, wrath and indignation. [There will be] tribulation and distress for every soul of man who does evil, of the Jew first and also of the Greek, but glory and honor and peace to everyone who does good, to the Jew first and also to the Greek. For there is no partiality with God.*

## Reflection

Day 8 in the Kindness | God's impartial judgment sequence opens with Romans 2:6-11. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: who WILL RENDER TO EACH PERSON ACCORDING TO HIS DEEDS: to those who by perseverance in doing good seek for glory and honor and immortality, eternal life; but to those who are selfishly ambitious and do not obey the truth,. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without displacing the original meaning: the Creator who speaks order is the same Lord

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:6-11 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about who WILL RENDER TO EACH PERSON ACCORDING TO slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about god's impartial judgment meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:6-11 calls you to live this truth today:

- Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Romans 2:6-11.
- Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:6-11 and for showing us who WILL RENDER TO EACH PERSON ACCORDING TO. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in God's impartial judgment. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:6-11 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 8 in the Kindness | God's impartial judgment sequence opens with Romans 2:6-11. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Make our lives more truthful, more restful, and more loving because Your word has met us here. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*Extraordinary afflictions are not always the punishment of extraordinary sins, but sometimes the trial of extraordinary graces.*

- Matthew Henry, Matthew Henry's Commentary on the Whole Bible

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:12-16 (NASB)

*For all who have sinned without the Law will also perish without the Law, and all who have sinned under the Law will be judged by the Law; for [it is] not the hearers of the Law [who] are just before God, but the doers of the Law will be justified. For when Gentiles who do not have the Law do instinctively the things of the Law, these, not having the Law, are a law to themselves, in that they show the work of the Law written in their hearts, their conscience bearing witness and their thoughts alternately accusing or else defending them, on the day when, according to my gospel, God will judge the secrets of men through Christ Jesus.*

## Reflection

Day 9 in the Truth | The law written on the heart sequence opens with Romans 2:12-16. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: For all who have sinned without the Law will also perish without the Law, and all who have sinned under the Law will be judged by the Law; for [it is] not the hearers of the Law [who] are just. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without displacing the original meaning:

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:12-16 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about For all who have sinned without the Law slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about the law written on the heart meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:12-16 calls you to live this truth today:

- Write one sentence naming what The law written on the heart reveals about God's character, and return to it at midday.
- Choose one ordinary responsibility today and do it slowly, truthfully, and without grumbling.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:12-16 and for showing us For all who have sinned without the Law. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in The law written on the heart. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:12-16 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 9 in the Truth | The law written on the heart sequence opens with Romans 2:12-16. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*Though we cannot think alike, may we not love alike?*

- John Wesley, Sermons and Tracts

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:17-24 (NASB)

*But if you bear the name 'Jew ' and rely upon the Law and boast in God, and know [His] will and approve the things that are essential, being instructed out of the Law, and are confident that you yourself are a guide to the blind, a light to those who are in darkness, a corrector of the foolish, a teacher of the immature, having in the Law the embodiment of knowledge and of the truth, you, therefore, who teach another, do you not teach yourself? You who preach that one shall not steal, do you steal? You who say that one should not commit adultery, do you commit adultery? You who abhor idols, do you rob temples? You who boast in the Law, through your breaking the Law, do you dishonor God? For 'THE NAME OF GOD IS BLASPHEMED AMONG THE GENTILES BECAUSE OF YOU,' just as it is written.*

## Reflection

Day 10 in the Integrity | Teaching others while ignoring yourself sequence opens with Romans 2:17-24. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: But if the reader bear the name 'Jew ' and rely upon the Law and boast in God, and know [His] will and approve the things that are essential, being instructed out of the Law, and are confident that the reader yourself. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:17-24 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about But if you bear the name Jew slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about teaching others while ignoring yourself meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:17-24 calls you to live this truth today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Romans 2:17-24 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:17-24 and for showing us But if you bear the name Jew. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in Teaching others while ignoring yourself. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:17-24 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 10 in the Integrity | Teaching others while ignoring yourself sequence opens with Romans 2:17-24. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Make our lives more truthful, more restful, and more loving because Your word has met us here. Amen.



# Timeless Wisdom

*Faith's greatest triumphs are achieved in the hour of deepest darkness.*

- Samuel Rutherford, Letters of Samuel Rutherford

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:25-29 (NASB)

*For indeed circumcision is of value if you practice the Law; but if you are a transgressor of the Law, your circumcision has become uncircumcision. So if the uncircumcised man keeps the requirements of the Law, will not his uncircumcision be regarded as circumcision? And he who is physically uncircumcised, if he keeps the Law, will he not judge you who though having the letter [of the Law] and circumcision are a transgressor of the Law? For he is not a Jew who is one outwardly, nor is circumcision that which is outward in the flesh. But he is a Jew who is one inwardly; and circumcision is that which is of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter; and his praise is not from men, but from God.*

## Reflection

Day 11 in the Covenant | True circumcision of the heart sequence opens with Romans 2:25-29. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: For indeed circumcision is of value if the reader practice the Law; but if the reader are a transgressor of the Law, the reader's circumcision has become uncircumcision. So if the uncircumcised man keeps the requirements of the Law, will not his uncircumcision. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:25-29 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about For indeed circumcision is of value if you slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about true circumcision of the heart meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:25-29 calls you to live this truth today:

- Name one place where you have been trying to control the outcome, and entrust that concern to God in prayer.
- End the day by recording one evidence of God's goodness you noticed in work, rest, or relationships.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:25-29 and for showing us For indeed circumcision is of value if you. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in True circumcision of the heart. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:25-29 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 11 in the Covenant | True circumcision of the heart sequence opens with Romans 2:25-29. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

# Timeless Wisdom

*The way to be humble is to behold Christ's humility.*

- Thomas Watson, A Body of Divinity

## Scripture Reading

Rom 2:28-29 (NASB)

*For he is not a Jew who is one outwardly, nor is circumcision that which is outward in the flesh. But he is a Jew who is one inwardly; and circumcision is that which is of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter; and his praise is not from men, but from God.*

## Reflection

Day 12 in the Grace | The gospel and the changed heart sequence opens with Romans 2:28-29. The text begins with a decisive confession of divine initiative: For he is not a Jew who is one outwardly, nor is circumcision that which is outward in the flesh. But he is a Jew who is one inwardly; and circumcision is that which is of the heart, by the Spirit. Creation does not unfold as accident or chaos but as deliberate speech from God. Every boundary in the passage communicates order, purpose, and moral direction. Light is named good, darkness is bounded, and time is given a rhythm that frames human life. The first movement of interpretation therefore starts with God, not with human achievement. The heart of the passage is not merely that something began; the heart is that the Lord governs what begins, what continues, and what is declared good. The context paragraph must also face the human condition implied by the text. When creation is narrated as gift, anxiety loses authority as a ruling voice. When existence is spoken by God, identity is received rather than invented. This rebukes the habit of treating worth as a product of output, applause, or control. The canonical setting presses this contrast with force: Israel heard creation theology while living amid rival stories that linked power to violence and fertility to fear. Genesis instead binds meaning to covenantal goodness. The passage therefore addresses both ancient idolatry and present forms of self-justification. The theological paragraph follows naturally. God's character is revealed as wise, generous, and trustworthy. Divine speech is effective; divine judgment is truthful; divine presence is sustaining. This frames Christ-centered reading without displacing the original meaning: the Creator who speaks order is the same Lord who reconciles creation through grace. The result is not moralism but worship. Faithful obedience grows from confidence in God's prior action. Holiness becomes response, not currency. Hope becomes grounded in God's constancy, not in fluctuating circumstances. The bridge to practice is concrete. Speech is to be truthful because God's word is true. Work is to be ordered because creation is ordered. Rest is to be honored because the passage assigns cadence to time. Neighbor-love

## Still Before God

- Sit with Romans 2:28-29 for two quiet minutes. Read the line about For he is not a Jew who is slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- How does this passage about the gospel and the changed heart meet your life today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

## Walk It Out

Because Romans 2:28-29 calls you to live this truth today:

→ Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Romans 2:28-29.

→ Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

## Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Romans 2:28-29 and for showing us For he is not a Jew who is. You have not left us to guess at Your character, because this passage reveals Your wisdom in The gospel and the changed heart. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Where our hearts are anxious or divided, use Romans 2:28-29 to steady us in what is true and good. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Day 12 in the Grace | The gospel and the changed heart sequence opens with Romans 2:28-29. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from fear. Help us practice the obedience this day requires with humility, patience, and gratitude. Amen.

## Footnotes

1. Arthur W. Pink, *Profiting from the Word*, (1932).
2. Jonathan Edwards, *Resolutions*, (1722).
3. John Owen, *Of the Mortification of Sin*, (1656).
4. Charles H. Spurgeon, *Spurgeon's Sermons*, (1873).
5. John Bunyan, *A Discourse on Prayer*, (1662).
6. John Calvin, *Sermons and Letters*, (1561).
7. George Whitefield, *Journals of George Whitefield*, (1771).
8. Martin Luther, *Table Talk*, (1566).
9. Matthew Henry, *Matthew Henry's Commentary on the Whole Bible*, (1706).
10. John Wesley, *Sermons and Tracts*, (1770).
11. Samuel Rutherford, *Letters of Samuel Rutherford*, (1664).
12. Thomas Watson, *A Body of Divinity*, (1692).

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